

the inventors.

Morry Marshall, vice president, strategic technologies, Semicore Research, said, "Quantum film gathers more light so you can either make a smaller image sensor for a less expensive cellphone camera, or you make a higher-resolution sensor for high-end digital cameras."

'Spy in sky' to track vehicles

In the US, military scientists are developing a remote-controlled airborne detection system that can bounce radar off buildings and follow a vehicle even through heavy traffic in the city. They are calling it a 'spy in sky.'

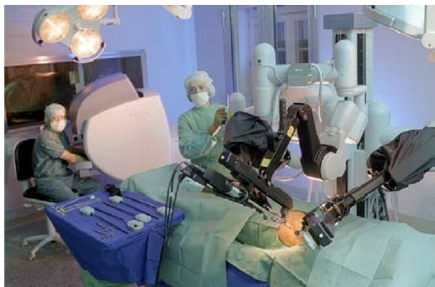
Being developed by Pentagon's Defence Advanced Research Projects Agency, the new radar system sees around corners and down into 'urban canyons'—in fact, it can track vehicles across an entire city using just a few uncrewed aircrafts.

Traditional radar requires direct line of sight, so it's often difficult to track a vehicle that keeps nipping behind buildings. But the DARPA scientists believe that by using buildings as mirrors, the multipath exploitation radar could identify a target vehicle from radar reflections.

IE 9 will not support Windows XP

It's been only a few days since Microsoft unveiled the first preview of Internet Explorer 9 (IE9) Web browser and here's the sting: it will not be supported for Windows XP systems.

Microsoft had hinted on the incompatibility of Microsoft XP with its new browser version pointing out security and performance issues. But this rev-



da Vinci robotic surgery

elation soon after the preview could be seen as a strategy to drive both business and consumers away from Windows XP towards the new Windows 7.

Robot to conduct surgery in Gujarat hospital

Nadiad Kidney Hospital, a 170-bed charitable hospital in Gujarat, will soon have a Rs 1-billion da Vinci robot to conduct urology surgeries.

According to Mahesh Desai, managing trustee and chairman, department of urology, the robot-assisted surgery can less than halve the post-operation recovery time. It will also enable an experienced doctor to pre-side over two or three simultaneous operations from his chamber while young doctors man the procedure along with the robot.

Nadiad Kidney hospital is planning to extend the services of the robot to other surgical fields apart from

urology, like pediatrics, gynaecology and oncology, to make the service cost-effective.

Power from water waste

Manoj Mandelia, a student at IIT Kharagpur, has demonstrated with the project LOCUS (Localised Operation of Bio-cells Using Sewage) that wastewater can be used for producing electricity.

The product uses the concept of microbial fuel cell (MFC)—a bio-electrochemical system—that drives current by mimicking bacterial interactions found in nature. This not only treats wastewater but also produces electricity in the process. It can achieve chemical oxygen demand reduction levels in wastewater to 60-80 per cent.

The microbial fuel cell is integrated with sewage treatment systems to treat wastewater and simultaneously generate electricity.

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